

AI Training Data PII Policy

Student version | Policy document for conversion into Policy-as-Code

Policy metadata	Value
Policy ID	AI-DP-PII-001
Policy name	AI Training Data PII Policy
Version	1.0
Classification	Internal
Policy owner	Data Protection Office
Applies to	Training, testing, fine-tuning and evaluation datasets used for AI, ML and analytics
Review cycle	Annual or upon material change to privacy, AI or data governance requirements

1. Purpose

This policy defines mandatory requirements for identifying, flagging and remediating personal data in datasets used for artificial intelligence, machine learning, model fine-tuning, model evaluation and analytics activities.

2. Scope

This policy applies to all datasets that are proposed for AI or machine learning use, including raw data, curated training data, labelled data, test data, validation data, embeddings, logs, prompts, responses and synthetic data derived from personal data.

3. Policy Objective

Datasets must be assessed before use. Records containing personal data must be flagged. Records containing unresolved personal data must not be used for AI training, fine-tuning or evaluation unless an approved exception is recorded.

4. Definitions

Term	Policy definition
Personal data / PII	Information that identifies, or can reasonably identify, a living individual either directly or in combination with other information.
Direct identifier	A data item that can identify an individual on its own.
Indirect identifier	A data item that may identify an individual when combined with other information.
Sensitive personal data	More sensitive information such as health, ethnicity, religion, political opinion, biometric or genetic information.
Training data	Any dataset used to train, fine-tune, evaluate or improve an AI, ML or analytics model.
Flagged record	A dataset record where one or more policy rules identify personal data or suspected personal data.
Remediation	Action taken to remove, mask, tokenise, generalise or anonymise personal data before dataset use.

5. PII Classification Catalogue

5.1 Direct identifiers

The following fields are treated as personal data when present in training data and must be flagged.

Rule ID	PII type	Examples	Required policy outcome
PII-01	Full name	first_name, last_name, full_name, customer_name	Flag record
PII-02	Personal email address	email, personal_email, contact_email	Flag record
PII-03	Phone or mobile number	mobile, telephone, phone_number	Flag record
PII-04	Postal or home address	address, home_address, street, postcode with address	Flag record
PII-05	National Insurance number	ni_number, nino	Block until removed or approved
PII-06	Passport number	passport_number	Block until removed or approved
PII-07	Driving licence number	driving_licence_number	Block until removed or approved
PII-08	Bank account or payment card number	bank_account, sort_code, credit_card_number	Block until removed or approved
PII-09	Online identifier	IP address, device ID, cookie ID, user ID where linkable to a person	Flag record

5.2 Sensitive personal data

The following fields are treated as sensitive personal data when present in training data and must be blocked unless a documented approval exists.

Rule ID	Sensitive data type	Examples	Required policy outcome
SPII-01	Health or medical information	medical_condition, diagnosis, treatment, disability information	Block record
SPII-02	Ethnicity or racial origin	ethnicity, race, racial_origin	Block record
SPII-03	Religion or belief	religion, belief	Block record
SPII-04	Political opinion	political_view, party_preference	Block record
SPII-05	Trade union membership	union_member, trade_union	Block record
SPII-06	Biometric or genetic data	faceprint, fingerprint, iris_scan, DNA profile	Block record

5.3 Indirect identifiers and combination rules

Some fields may not identify a person on their own but can identify a person when combined with other attributes. The following combinations must be flagged as personal data.

Rule ID	Combination rule	Required policy outcome
CPII-01	Full name + date of birth	Flag record
CPII-02	Full name + postal address or postcode	Flag record
CPII-03	Full name + phone number	Flag record
CPII-04	Full name + personal email address	Flag record
CPII-05	Date of birth + postcode + gender	Flag record
CPII-06	Employee ID + department + role where linkable to a person	Flag record
CPII-07	Customer ID + account event details where the customer can be re-identified	Flag record
CPII-08	Free-text comments containing personal identifiers	Flag record

6. Mandatory Policy Requirements

Rule ID	Policy requirement	Policy statement
DP-01	Pre-use scan	Training data must be scanned for personal data before it is used for model training, fine-tuning, testing or evaluation.
DP-02	Record-level flagging	Each record containing direct, sensitive or combination-based personal data must be flagged.
DP-03	Direct identifier handling	Direct identifiers must be removed, masked, tokenised or replaced before the record is approved for training use.
DP-04	Sensitive data handling	Sensitive personal data must be blocked from training data unless a documented approval and control justification exists.
DP-05	Combination rule handling	Records matching combination rules must be reviewed and remediated before use.
DP-06	Free-text scanning	Free-text fields such as comments, notes, feedback and descriptions must be scanned for personal data patterns.
DP-07	Remediation evidence	Every remediated record must retain evidence of the remediation method applied.
DP-08	Approved dataset output	Only records with no unresolved personal data findings may be included in the approved training dataset.
DP-09	Exception handling	Exceptions must be documented, risk-assessed, time-bound and approved by the Data Protection Office or delegated authority.
DP-10	Audit trail	The scan result, triggered rule, decision, remediation status and approver must be retained for audit purposes.

7. Dataset Decision Outcomes

Decision	Meaning	Required action
PASS	No personal data or suspected personal data has been detected.	Record may be included in the approved training dataset.
FLAG	Direct or combination-based personal data has been detected.	Record must be remediated before training use.
BLOCK	Sensitive personal data or high-risk identifier has been detected.	Record must be excluded unless approved exception exists.
EXCEPTION APPROVED	A documented approval allows controlled use of the record.	Use only under the approved conditions and retain audit evidence.

8. Remediation Requirements

Remediation method	Policy expectation
Removal	Delete the personal data field or remove the record where the field is not required.
Masking	Replace part of the value while preserving limited analytical utility, where appropriate.
Tokenisation	Replace the identifier with a non-identifying token.
Generalisation	Reduce precision, such as replacing exact date of birth with age band.
Anonymisation	Transform data so individuals are no longer reasonably identifiable.

9. Minimum Evidence Required

Evidence item	Requirement
Dataset name	Name and version of the dataset assessed.
Scan date	Date when the dataset was scanned.
Triggered rule IDs	List of policy rules triggered by each flagged record.
Decision	PASS, FLAG, BLOCK or EXCEPTION APPROVED.
Remediation status	Not required, pending, completed or exception approved.
Reviewer or approver	Named reviewer or approval reference where required.

10. Non-compliance

Datasets with unresolved personal data findings must not be used for AI training, fine-tuning, testing or evaluation. Non-compliance may result in suspension of dataset use, removal of system access, escalation to the data owner, supplier remediation or other action determined by the organisation.

11. Policy Review

This policy must be reviewed at least annually or when there is a material change to privacy, AI governance, data use, model development or regulatory requirements.

Document control

Version	Date	Summary of change	Owner
1.0	24 July 2026	Initial student version for AI training data PII policy-as-code exercise.	Data Protection Office

Formatting specification used for this PDF

A4 page size with approximately 18 mm side margins; dark blue section hierarchy; light blue alternating table rows; clean sans-serif typography; compact 7–8 pt table text; 9.2 pt body text; 14 pt section headings; 21 pt title; consistent footer and page numbering.